



YOU ARE **31 WEEKS AND 2 DAYS**

**61 days to go**

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### **YOUR BABY TODAY**

Your baby's hand coordination continues to improve as their brain is better able to make sense of the feedback it receives. The eyes will often open but only for short periods at a time, reducing the chance of a stray finger coming too close.

**“ By this stage, your baby is the length they'll be at birth, but they're still very thin and need to gain fat and muscle. ”**

At this stage of pregnancy, your baby's muscle mass and fat are continuing to increase. Their skin is now thicker and less translucent, and begins to look pink rather than red as the underlying blood vessels are overlaid with more flesh. Growth hormone is being produced by your baby's pituitary gland but before they're actually born this does not influence their growth. Instead insulin and insulin-like growth factors are key. As your baby's skeleton is now close to its final size, their overall length is established. Your baby is still, however, very skinny.

A sonographer can make a good estimate of your baby's weight from an ultrasound scan, but this may vary to your baby's actual weight by plus or minus one pound. Your baby will continue to grow throughout the pregnancy, although in the last few weeks growth is mainly due to fat deposits rather than to muscle mass.

If you're trying to guess how heavy your baby will be at birth, the latest research indicates that the size of your baby has a lot to do with “imprinted” genes. These are genes that are marked as having come from the father, which promote the baby's growth, or the mother, which are growth limiting and attempt to preserve her resources.

### **FOCUS ON TWINS**

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**Twins look adorable when they're dressed alike**, so you may be buying—and certainly will be given—lots of sets of matching clothing. But it's much easier to tell identical twins apart when they're dressed differently. It also helps everyone relate to them as individuals, which is good for their development.

Also keep practicalities in mind: every time one of your twins gets dirty, are you going to change them both? You may find it pays to be flexible: if there are only two clean onesies, then that is what they'll have to wear, regardless of style or color match.

If you get into the habit of dressing them the same, all the time, they may grow conscious of this in toddler years and get distressed if they're dressed differently.

You could: